

Psalms 118

This Is the Day Which the Lord Hath Made

This is the day which the Lord hath made; we will rejoice and be glad in it
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 O give thanks unto the LORD; for he is good: because his mercy endureth for ever.
- 2 Let Israel now say, that his mercy endureth for ever.
- 3 Let the house of Aaron now say, that his mercy endureth for ever.
- 4 Let them now that fear the LORD say, that his mercy endureth for ever.
- 5 I called upon the LORD in distress: the LORD answered me, and set me in a large place.
- 6 The LORD is on my side; I will not fear: what can man do unto me?
- 7 The LORD taketh my part with them that help me: therefore shall I see my desire upon them that hate me.
- 8 It is better to trust in the LORD than to put confidence in man.
- 9 It is better to trust in the LORD than to put confidence in princes.
- 10 All nations compassed me about: but in the name of the LORD will I destroy them.
- 11 They compassed me about; yea, they compassed me about: but in the name of the LORD I will destroy them.
- 12 They compassed me about like bees; they are quenched as the fire of thorns: for in the name of the LORD I will destroy them.
- 13 Thou hast thrust sore at me that I might fall: but the LORD helped me.
- 14 The LORD is my strength and song, and is become my salvation.
- 15 The voice of rejoicing and salvation is in the tabernacles of the righteous: the right hand of the LORD doeth valiantly.
- 16 The right hand of the LORD is exalted: the right hand of the LORD doeth valiantly.
- 17 I shall not die, but live, and declare the works of the LORD.
- 18 The LORD hath chastened me sore: but he hath not given me over unto death.
- 19 Open to me the gates of righteousness: I will go into them, and I will praise the LORD:
- 20 This gate of the LORD, into which the righteous shall enter.
- 21 I will praise thee: for thou hast heard me, and art become my salvation.
- 22 The stone which the builders refused is become the head stone of the corner.
- 23 This is the LORD'S doing; it is marvellous in our eyes.
- 24 This is the day which the LORD hath made; we will rejoice and be glad in it.
- 25 Save now, I beseech thee, O LORD: O LORD, I beseech thee, send now prosperity.
- 26 Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the LORD: we have blessed you out of the house of the LORD.
- 27 God is the LORD, which hath shewed us light: bind the sacrifice with cords, even unto the horns of the altar.
- 28 Thou art my God, and I will praise thee: thou art my God, I will exalt thee.
- 29 O give thanks unto the LORD; for he is good: for his mercy endureth for ever.

2 · CONTEXT

Psalm 118 closes the Egyptian Hallel with a processional thanksgiving for deliverance from surrounding enemies, moving from communal refrain to intensely personal testimony and on to the striking image of a rejected stone becoming the cornerstone. Its language is quoted directly by Jesus regarding His own rejection and vindication (Matthew 21:42), and by the crowds at His triumphal entry (Matthew 21:9); Henry reads the whole psalm as ultimately pointing beyond any single deliverance to Christ's own rejection and exaltation.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-4

The opening call to thanksgiving is issued in successive waves—to Israel, to the house of Aaron, to all who fear the Lord—each affirming the same refrain: His mercy endures forever. Repetition itself becomes an act of corporate testimony, drawing every part of the worshipping community into the same declaration.

Verse 5-9

Personal testimony follows: calling on the Lord in distress and being answered, set in a large place, no longer afraid because the Lord is on his side. The conclusion drawn is blunt and comparative: better to trust in the Lord than to put confidence in man, better to trust in the Lord than in princes—human help measured directly against divine and found insufficient.

Verse 10-14

Being surrounded by hostile nations is recalled vividly, described three times over as being compassed about, yet each time answered by the same confidence: in the name of the Lord I will destroy them. Though thrust at severely, on the verge of falling, the Lord helped, becoming strength, song, and salvation.

Verse 15-18

Rejoicing and salvation are pictured filling the tabernacles of the righteous, the Lord's right hand doing valiantly and being exalted. Even severe chastening is acknowledged honestly—the Lord has chastened sorely—yet without being handed over to death, life itself preserved specifically in order to declare God's works.

Verse 19-21

A request to enter follows: open the gates of righteousness, so I may go in and praise the Lord—this gate belonging specifically to the righteous. Personal praise closes the movement: I will praise You, for You have heard me and become my salvation.

Verse 22-24

The psalm's most quoted image arrives: the stone the builders rejected has become the head of the corner—this is the Lord's doing, marvelous in our eyes. The refrain that gives the psalm its title follows directly: this is the day the Lord has made; we will rejoice and be glad in it.

Verse 25-29

A final urgent plea for salvation and prosperity leads into blessing pronounced on the one who comes in the Lord's name, welcomed from the house of the Lord. Light shown, sacrifice bound to the altar's horns, personal praise renewed—the psalm closes exactly as it opened: give thanks to the Lord, for He is good, His mercy enduring forever.

4 • MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Deliverance from real, surrounding hostility is celebrated here not as luck but as direct evidence that trusting the Lord outperforms any confidence placed in human strength or status, however severe the chastening endured along the way. The image of a rejected stone becoming the cornerstone reframes apparent failure or rejection as potentially the very means of God's marvelous, ultimately celebrated work—a pattern the New Testament identifies explicitly with Christ.

Application for life today.

Take verse 24 literally today, not as a generic sentiment but as a specific claim about this actual day—rehearse one concrete reason it can be received as made and given by the Lord. Notice verses 8–9's blunt comparison and examine where you are currently trusting 'man' or 'princes' more instinctively than you are trusting God in a present difficulty. Consider a place in your own life that felt like rejection or failure, and ask whether, as with the rejected stone, God might be doing something with it that is not yet visible.

5 • REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. What would it mean to take verse 24 literally today—not as a generic sentiment but as a specific claim about this actual day being made and given by the Lord?

2. Where are you currently trusting 'the help of man' or 'confidence in princes' (vv. 8–9) more instinctively than you are trusting God in a present difficulty?

3. What past rejection or failure in your own life might, like the stone the builders refused (v. 22), turn out to be part of something God is still building?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, *Commentary on the Whole Bible* (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).